As a result, Israel found itself attacked as the oppressor of a new "national liberation struggle" presented as "more authentic," emanating as it did from Arab Muslim victims of European "imperialism." By the mid-1970s, Israel was no longer perceived as a small country threatened by twenty-two Arab states, but as a "strong" power trying to "cruelly crush" a "small people" who "only" aspired to be free. European leaders found in this fairy-tale a good excuse to distance themselves from Israel and to accuse it of every imaginable crime.

Israel was now urged to find ways to coexist peacefully with an "invented" people who did not want to coexist with it. The entire raison d'être for Palestinism was as a weapon of war against Israel.

Terrorism against Israel fast became acceptable as "resistance" against "occupation." Even attacks against children in a toy store or in a restaurant were considered as "comprehensible." Every time Israel accepted a compromise and the "Palestinian leaders" said it was not enough, Israel was treated as the guilty party. The large number of Israelis killed under Clinton's presidency was treated as a mere detail.

However, when fewer Israelis were killed under the presidency of George W. Bush than in earlier years, he was accused of being "indifferent" to the "suffering" of the "Palestinians."

The global rise of radical Islam in the 1980s saw the creation of Hamas—a movement which is an integral part of the jihad against the West.[17] Hamas's declared aim is the genocidal destruction of Israel. Its stated way to achieve this aim is through terror attacks, called "armed struggle" by Hamas leaders. For many years, European countries did not define Hamas as a terrorist organization. As Hamas was fighting for the "Palestinians," it was considered by European leaders as a "resistance movement." Hamas only started to be regarded as a terrorist *organization* by the European Union in 2005. Many European leaders would mock the idea of negotiating with ISIS or al-Qaeda, but say that Israel should negotiate with Hamas. In other words, they are suggesting that Israel should negotiate with an organization dedicated to its complete destruction.

The first "Palestinian" terrorist attacks against Israel occurred in 1968, four years after the creation of the PLO, and one year after the unexpected victory of Israel in the Six-Day War.[18] Even though the Western media initially referred to "Palestinian terrorism," this terminology did not last. From the moment that such terrorism was associated with the "Palestinian cause," it became noble and brave. Terrorists were portrayed as "militants" or "activists." Killing Israeli Jews came to be considered by many journalists as being logical and making sense.

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